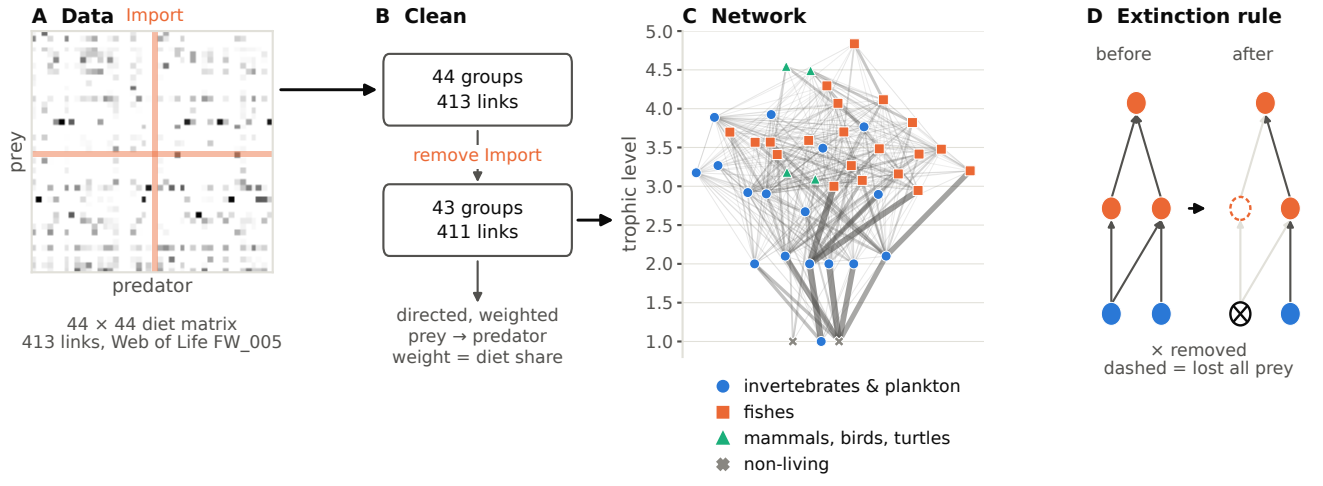

(A) The raw Gulf of Cadiz diet matrix (44×44), with columns representing predators and rows representing prey. Darker cells indicate that a prey group makes up a larger proportion of a predator's diet. The "Import" row and column represent food sources originating outside the Gulf of Cadiz. **(B)** The processed diet matrix after removing the "Import" row and column, leaving 43 functional groups and 411 feeding links. **(C)** Network visualization of the processed food web, with each node representing a functional group and each edge representing a feeding relationship. Edge thickness indicates the proportion of a predator's diet contributed by its prey. Nodes are arranged vertically by trophic level, with primary producers at the bottom and top predators near the top. **(D)** Diagram showing the extinction rule: a consumer group will die out when it loses its prey.